

Evergreen Tropical Trees (Neem) 28-Day Stabilization & Establishment Schedule

Purpose

Survival-first, agent-readable guidance for the first 28 days after planting or potting container-grown neem trees. This document enforces the 28-Day Plant Stabilization framework. P1 rules override all others.

I. Global Guardrails (P1)

- Plant only when soil is workable (not frozen or waterlogged).
- All watering decisions must be based on root-zone moisture, not calendar timing.
- Standing water beyond 24 hours indicates drainage failure; pause irrigation and correct conditions.
- Avoid quick-release fertilizer during establishment; never fertilize dry soil.
- If guidance conflicts, survival rules (P1) override all others.

II. Neem Environmental Constraints (P1)

- Neem is not frost tolerant. Any frost forecast requires immediate indoor relocation.
- Outdoor placement only when night temperatures remain consistently above 50°F (10°C).
- Outside tropical climates, neem must be treated as a container-grown tree.

III. Day 0: Planting / Potting (P1)

- Plant at the same depth as the container; never bury the stem base.
- Firm soil to eliminate air pockets.
- Water thoroughly until the root ball and surrounding soil are fully saturated.
- Mulch lightly if used, keeping mulch away from the stem.
- Gradually acclimate to full sun to prevent scorch.

IV. Days 1–7: Acute Establishment (P1)

- Inspect root-zone moisture daily; water deeply when soil begins to dry.
- Water at the base only; avoid foliar wetting.
- Provide temporary shade or wind protection during extreme conditions.
- Do not prune or fertilize.

V. Days 8–28: Stabilization & Transition (P1 / P2)

Days 8–14 (P1): Allow slight surface drying; continue frequent moisture checks; no visible growth is normal.

Days 15–21 (P2): Gradually extend watering intervals as soil moisture stabilizes.

Days 22–28 (P2): Shift to weather-responsive monitoring.

VI. Fertilization (P1–P3)

- No fertilization during the first 28 days (P1).
- Fertilization during heat stress or drought is prohibited (P2).

- Post-day-28 feeding may be considered only after clear active growth (P3).

VII. Indoor & Seasonal Handling (P2)

- Indoors: provide bright light and airflow; avoid cold drafts and heat vents.
- Monitor moisture during winter dry spells even if growth appears static.

VIII. Normal Adjustment vs Failure Signals (P1)

Normal: Temporary wilt that recovers after watering; slow or paused growth.

Failure Signals: Persistent wilt in wet soil, stem softening or blackening, rapid leaf drop after cold exposure.

Response: Treat wet-soil wilt as a drainage or temperature failure, not a watering deficit.

IX. Explicit Exclusions (P1)

During the first 28 days: no growth optimization, no pruning for shape, no routine pest treatments, and no performance or medicinal claims.

X. Lifecycle Transition (Post-28 Days) (P4)

After stabilization, transition to species-specific long-term care guidance. Optimization applies only after survival is assured.